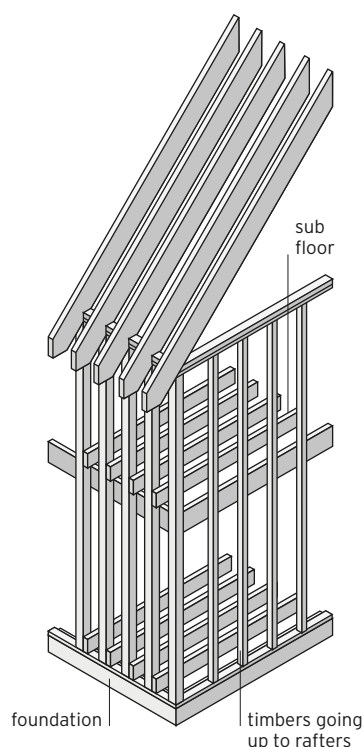




BALLOON FRAMING ▲ A type of timber construction used to build houses in which long timbers are used as supports extending from the foundations to the rafters. This contrasts with platform framing, in which each story is formed by floor-to-ceiling timbers topped by a floor deck that then becomes the platform for the next story.

BALUSTRADE A row of small columns topped by a rail, employed to prevent a person falling off a stairway, balcony, or terrace.

BAPTISTERY The area that surrounds the baptismal font in a church or cathedral. This may be incorporated within the body of the main structure, or it could be a separate building.

BARBICAN A fortified gate that protects the entrance to a city or castle. *See also* castle.

BARGEBOARD A board that runs under the slopes of a projecting gable roof. Historically, these were often decorated with carved or cut-out patterns. *See also* gable.

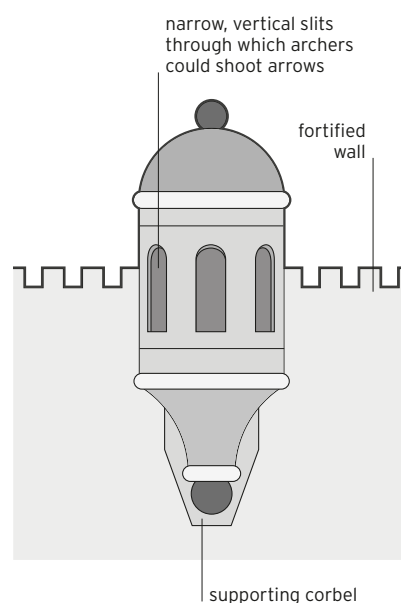
BARN An agricultural building, usually found on farms, used for storage purposes.

BAROQUE An architectural style originating in 17th-century Italy and pioneered by the Catholic Church, which looked to add dynamism and drama to the rules of Classical architecture. Floor plans incorporated ovals and curves, facades played with scale, and interiors employed theatrical effects through the manipulation of light, gilding, and extensive use of trompe l'oeil. *See also* Classical, trompe l'oeil.

BARREL VAULT A structure that acts like a series of arches placed one after another to make a semicylindrical ceiling, often seen in church or cathedral architecture. *See also* vault.

BARROW An elongated mound of earth or stones used in ancient times to cover a burial site.

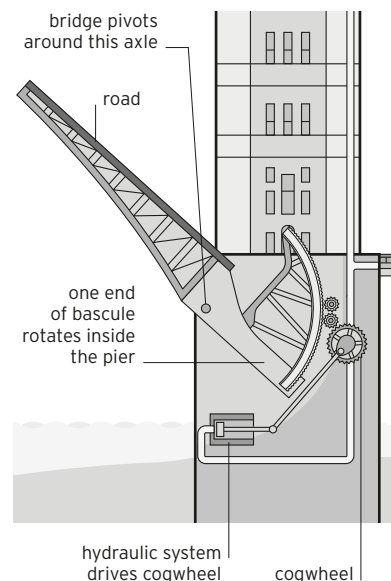
BARTIZAN ▼ A small kiosk or tower protruding from a fortified wall. Bartizans are most commonly found at corners to provide better defensive visibility and are furnished with arrow slits.



BAS-RELIEF A form of sculpture in which part of a flat material, such as wood or stone, is carved away

to create a shallow, raised three-dimensional effect. It was a favored decorative element in the cultures of ancient Egypt and Mesopotamia. *See also* relief carving.

BASCULE ▼ A moveable bridge that uses a counterweight to help raise its deck. It is sometimes referred to as a drawbridge.



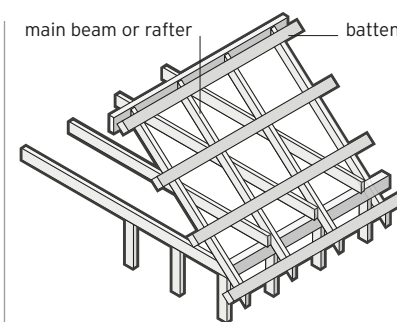
BASE The disk that forms the lowest part of a column, on which the cylindrical shaft sits. *See also* column.

BASEMENT The floor or floors of a building that are wholly or partially underground.

BASILICA Originally, an ancient Roman public building with a raised platform in an apse for the seating of officials. After the arrival of Christianity, the design was adopted for places of worship, featuring a central nave with a door at one end and an altar platform at the other end. *See also* altar, apse, nave.

BASTILLE A fortified tower or small fortress.

BASTION A structure that projects out from a castle or fortress wall. Bastions are most often angular in shape and situated at corners to give an improved range of defensive fire.



BATTEN ▲ Generally, a strip of timber, used as a secondary framework in construction, onto which a surface is fixed. For example, in roofing, battens are laid across the main structural beams and the tiling is laid on top of them.

BATTLEMENTS The crenellated top row of stones on a wall or tower. The alternating high parts (merlons) and gaps (crenels) provide cover to defending soldiers while allowing them to fire arrows. *See also* crenellation.

BAUHAUS A highly influential German art and design school operating from 1919 to 1933. It pioneered a Modernist and minimalist approach, characterized by the statement "form follows function." Utility was paramount, ornamentation was avoided, and there was an emphasis on uniting art and technology through the use of new materials and mass production.

BAY The space between architectural elements—for example, between columns or posts.

BAY WINDOW A window that projects outward from the wall of a building.

BAZAAR A Middle Eastern market, typically with a multitude of small shops and stalls in alleys, often with certain trades and types of goods grouped together. The alleys are sometimes roofed over, and historically there were gates so that the bazaar could be locked at night.